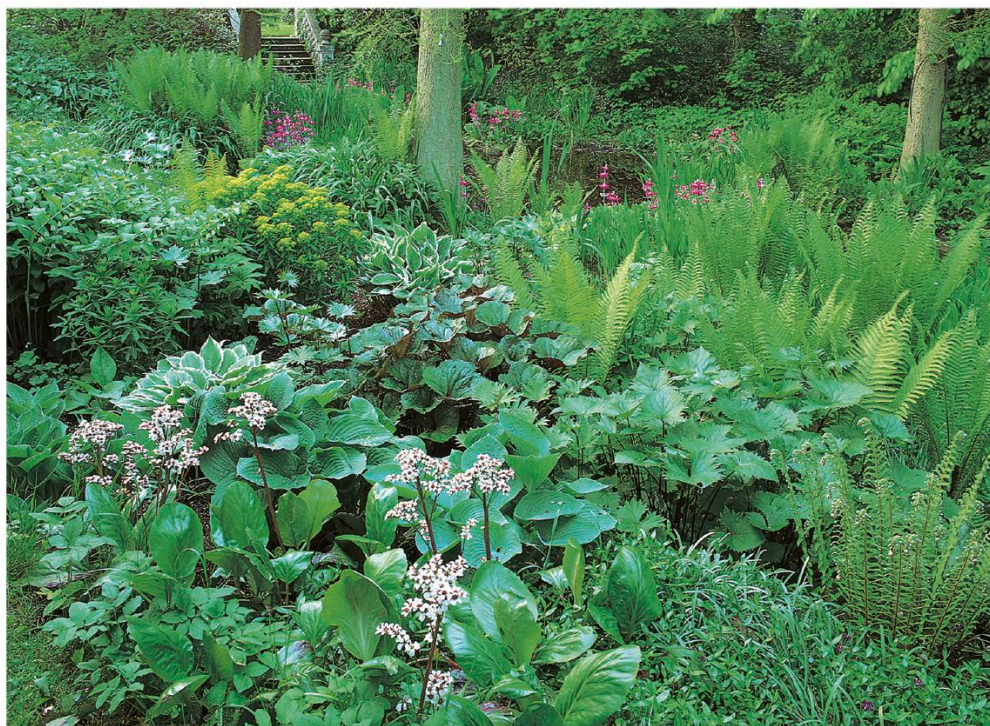




outlines of hostas in shady areas. Or use the stems of bleeding heart (*Lamprocapnos spectabilis*) and *Polygonatum x hybridum* to gracefully arch over shorter plants, such as heucheras and *Alchemilla mollis*.

When making your selections, consider the foliage shape, form, and texture as well as flower colors. The boldly pleated foliage of veratrums and delicate, pinnate leaves of *Polemonium caeruleum* are worthy of consideration, while furry verbascums are seductively tactile.

The disadvantage of planting herbaceous perennials is that the garden looks bare in winter, unless you plant sturdy types with long-lasting seedheads, such as rudbeckias,

ABOVE Contrasting foliage

In damp, dappled shade, elegant contrasts of foliage form and texture create an atmosphere of lush abundance. A selection of bergenias, hostas, ferns, and ligularias are included in this lush scheme.

hylotelephiums, sedums, and grasses. These can be left to provide interest until new shoots appear in spring. Prairie-style schemes use these types of plants for year-round interest; rather than planting in long borders, perennials and grasses are used in large, bold groups, with tall see-through plants in front of shorter ones. Just a few plant species are used, and repeated to mirror nature. The effects of prairie schemes are best seen in larger gardens.

DIVIDING PERENNIALS

This easy method of propagation can be used to propagate most herbaceous perennials as well as to rejuvenate large, tired clumps that are no longer flowering well. You can also divide newly bought perennials, providing they are large enough and have clearly divisible stems, to make the most of your purchases. Most perennials can be divided in fall or early spring just as the shoots appear.



1 Dig up the plant

In early spring, select a clump of plants and water them well. Cut back any old top growth to the ground. Using a fork, lift the clump of plants, being very careful to keep the whole rootball intact.



2 Divide with forks

Cut solid crowns into portions with a spade or old bread knife. If you cannot pry other pieces apart by hand, use two forks held back-to-back to split the clump into smaller sections.



3 Replant the divisions

Discard the dead central portions of overgrown clumps. Replant healthy, hand-sized pieces with strong buds in soil improved with well-rotted organic matter, such as manure. Water in well.

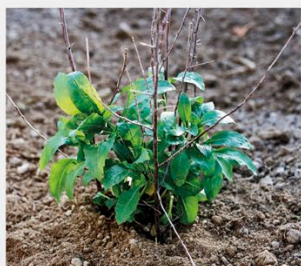
STAKING BORDER PERENNIALS

Many tall perennials, such as delphiniums and achilleas, become top-heavy and require some form of support. If you provide plant supports early in the season, the plants will grow through and disguise them. Plants staked at a later date, especially once they have already flopped, always tend to look trussed up.



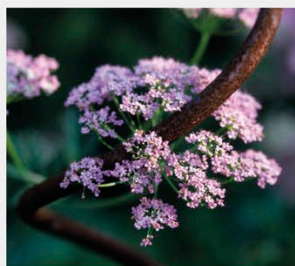
Using canes

Bamboo canes are ideal for supporting tall flowers such as delphiniums. Use soft twine to tie the stems to the supports.



Using twiggy sticks

Plants with moundlike growth will grow through and be supported by twiggy sticks placed around stems in spring.



Using metal spirals

Metal spirals provide good support for perennials such as this *Pimpinella*, and also make decorative features.